
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

The English We Speak

Doomscrolling

The logo for BBC Learning English, featuring the letters 'BBC' in a white box above the words 'LEARNING ENGLISH' in white capital letters, all on a teal background.

This is not a word-for-word transcript

Feifei

Hello and welcome to The English We Speak. I'm Feifei... err Rob, could we have your attention please?

Rob

... oh sorry, Feifei, I was just looking at the news on my smartphone.

Feifei

Now is not the time to be looking at the news – we are presenting a programme.

Rob

I know, but there's so much news to look at and it's all very very...

Feifei

...depressing? Yes, there has been a lot of depressing news recently, but you seem addicted to it.

Rob

Look at this! Did you know we are all going to die... some day?

Feifei

Enough *doomscrolling*, Rob!

Rob

What's that?

Feifei

'Doomscrolling' describes continuously scrolling through endless bad news stories on your smartphone app, on social media or on the internet. It happens a lot during the coronavirus pandemic. And you're obsessed, Rob – you just can't stop reading information that depresses you.

Rob

OK, OK – I'll try to find some more positive news while we hear some examples...

Examples

I've been doomscrolling too much and read so much information about coronavirus that I can't sleep at night.

Stop doomscrolling! If you read too much bad news you'll get depressed.

My brother does too much doomsurfing – he loves to tell us the latest gloom and doom in the world, so we've stopped listening to him!

Feifei

This is The English We Speak from BBC Learning English and we're talking about doomscrolling – also called doomsurfing. That's endlessly looking at depressing news stories on your smartphone app, on social media or the internet. I think it's time we had some good news stories, Rob.

Rob

Yes – and I think I have one. Look, a kitten that went missing has been found...

Feifei

Sweet!

Rob

... and look at this – new research says biscuits don't make you fat... and this story...

Feifei

OK, Rob. Is there a word for endlessly looking at good news stories?

Rob

Joyscrolling? Happyscrolling?

Feifei

Well, it's good to see you smiling again.

Rob

Well we all need something to smile about after the events of this year.

Feifei

I agree. Bye.

Rob

Bye.